

hybrids. For a shorter distance these cars can run fully electric and even at significantly lower speeds. They cost more than a mild hybrid and also provide better fuel efficiency.

**Fun Fact** - A lot of you may think that a jolt may be felt when a strong hybrid shifts 'taking its power from a combustion engine to an electric motor' but no. The difference is minimal and people who have driven these vehicles confirmed that.

But while there may be new technology on the market, is it really worth taking that plunge? If you are in the market for a new car, with fuel costs sky-rocketing, does it make sense to make a shift from the good old petrol and diesel vehicles?



**Rulers of the road**

## Difference in cost of owning these vehicles

In this section we explore that if you are a potential vehicle buyer, would it make sense for you to ditch an ICE and go the Electric or the Hybrid Vehicle way.

There are some costs that come with a vehicle, majorly two.

One is the initial cost and the other cost is the running cost. The initial cost is the cost of the vehicle added with costs like insurance and registration. The running cost of a vehicle is the fuel cost or the electricity cost depending on the type of vehicle you own. And the other type of cost in this is the maintenance cost of various parts of the vehicle that may require replacement and so on.

While factoring in the costs there are some things that should not be ignored at all.

ICE vehicles obviously, will have higher maintenance and running costs because of there being more components in the engine that may require replacement and also the ever

increasing fuel prices. Hybrids on the other hand have a higher initial cost because of the mechanics that go into making them and the number of components that they use.

An absolute difference cannot be commented on at this moment. There are some unknown factors. One is the resale value that these vehicles may get. A clear number on this has not come in as not that many have appeared in the second-hand car market as of now to present a cost and to tell the reader about the gains/losses you might have and how they compare to ICE vehicles.

What a consumer should really look at is use-case and what suits them best.

## What's next and what does the future look like?

As is the case with anything that enters the market, they tend to face some obstacles on the way. Now these obstacles were faced by EVs in a major way in the past. 'Range Anxiety' was the first one which basically described the anxiety that people faced about whether or not their vehicle will be able to go the distance they want it to or not. But with new launches, that is slowly disappearing. In comes the problem of the problem with new technology. This was the problem of there being major recalls in EV segment cars. Recalls are when



**Charges really quickly... They say**

a company finds that there is a certain component in a batch of already-produced cars that is not functioning like it is supposed to, so the company issues an announcement wherein all cars of that batch are called to their service stations so that that specific part can be replaced. While there is nothing new in there being a recall, but as one can imagine, they do not instill a lot of confidence among the buyers and this year that was did see some major recalls.

Some of them were not that big, in all honesty. But the fact is there are a lot of new companies hoping to make their mark in the EV segment and they seem to be facing some challenges. Some of these were recalls of menial issues. For example Amazon-backed Rivian, in October 2022 recalled 13,000 vehicles because of a possible loose fastener that was causing the driver to lose steering control. The solution just required the service station to fix two or three loose bolts but it still had to be done. But it does not all look bad for these vehicles. Because there is awareness of how these vehicles may be more environment friendly the governments do have subsidies on them. While these subsidies may depend on when and most importantly from where (these subsidies are mostly by state governments) you buy the vehicle there are some 'sweet' savings you may actually make because in some states your registration is free if you buy these vehicles, in some states insurance is free and so on. Such policies will go a long way in increasing EV adoption in the country by encouraging the masses to switch over. **d**

**"Even if you have to pay more up front, or even if your monthly rental is a little higher, the reduced running cost through electricity is much cheaper than petrol or diesel; there is a reduced service, maintenance, and repair (SMR) cost from the fact there are fewer mechanical working parts, so there is less to replace on every service, and that can change the perception of pricing in the customers' minds," says Helen Lees, head of electric vehicles and connected services at Groupe PSA said in an interview to FleetComplete**